Bigger but Less Profitable: Kaspi.kz after the Hepsiburada Acquisition

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Summary. In January 2025 Kaspi.kz, a leading Kazakh fintech and e-commerce company, bought a controlling stake in Hepsiburada, a leading Turkish online marketplace. Based on Kaspi's annual report for 2025, this note shows that the deal lifted revenue by 60% but left net income almost flat, cutting the net margin from 41.7% to 26.4%. The Kazakh business remained highly profitable, and the fall in margin comes from the Turkish business.

1. The company

Kaspi.kz operates a "super app" that combines payments, online shopping and personal finance. At the end of 2025 the app had about 15.7 million monthly active users, 68% of whom used it every day, and about 764,000 active merchants [1]. The company reports three segments: Payments, Marketplace (e-commerce) and Fintech (consumer loans and deposits). Its shares are listed on NASDAQ under the ticker KSPI.

2. Results, 2023-2025

Table 1. Kaspi.kz key financials, ₸ million

	2023	2024	2025
Payments	478,684	587,097	658,726
Marketplace	448,223	732,943	1,931,472
Fintech	1,026,721	1,281,827	1,542,934
Total revenue	**1,913,490**	**2,532,156**	**4,046,074**
Net income	**848,770**	**1,056,834**	**1,067,707**
Revenue growth	n/a	+32.3%	+59.8%
Net income growth	n/a	+24.5%	+1.0%
Net margin	44.4%	41.7%	26.4%
Marketplace share of segment revenue	22.9%	28.3%	47.1%

Note: segment revenue is shown before inter-segment eliminations and customer rewards, so the three segments do not add up exactly to total revenue. Source: [1], segment and earnings notes, pp. F-33 to F-42; growth and margins calculated from these figures.

Figure 1. Segment revenue, ₸ trillion

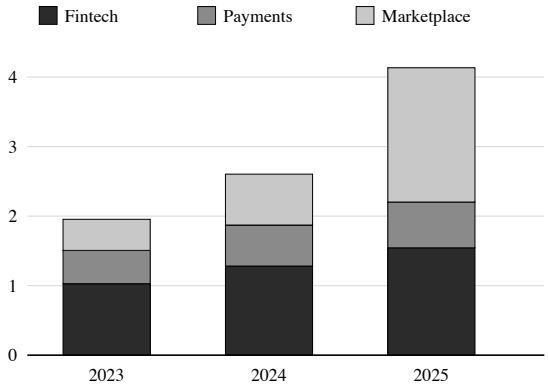
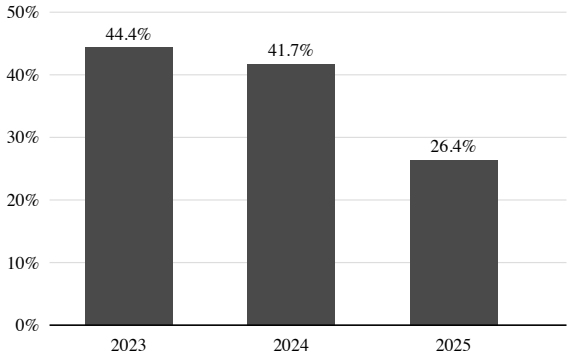


Figure 2. Net margin (net income / revenue)



Revenue grew by 32% in 2024 and by 60% in 2025, but net income grew by 25% and then by only 1%. As a result, the net margin, which had been above 40%, fell to 26% in 2025. The Marketplace segment changed most: its share of segment revenue rose from 23% in 2023 to 47% in 2025, making it Kaspi's largest business.

3. What changed in 2025

On 29 January 2025 Kaspi bought 65.4% of Hepsiburada for about $1.13 billion. It raised its stake to 76% in December 2025 and signed an agreement in January 2026 that took it to 85% [1]. The company itself calls this its first meaningful step toward international expansion.

The acquisition explains almost all of the change in the numbers. In 2025 the Turkish business added ₸1.03 trillion of segment revenue but made a net loss of ₸93 billion. Kazakhstan and Kaspi's other markets, by contrast, earned ₸1.16 trillion of net income on ₸3.07 trillion of segment revenue [1]. In other words, the core business remained very profitable, and the lower group margin reflects the new, loss-making Turkish business.

4. Risks

Three risks seem most important. First, Hepsiburada still loses money, and the key test for 2026 is whether these losses shrink. Second, Turkey has high inflation and a weak lira, and the deal was paid in U.S. dollars, which increases Kaspi's exposure to exchange-rate risk. Third, integration may be difficult: Kaspi warns that its international expansion may fail, and before the deal Hepsiburada had reported weaknesses in its internal financial controls [1].

5. Author's view

I don't consider the fall in margin a big problem. Large acquisitions and investments dilute margins at first, because the new business is not yet as profitable as the main one. In my opinion, it is a great tactic to grow Kaspi beyond Kazakhstan, because it gives the company more ways to make a profit. I would buy Kaspi shares as a long-term investment.

References

1. Kaspi.kz JSC. Annual Report on Form 20-F for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2025. U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission filing; also available at https://ir.kaspi.kz